REPORT ON PYLADIES MEETUP, HELD IN KAMPALA ON 12TH APRIL 2025

PyLadies

PyLadies is an international mentorship group with a focus on helping more women to become active participants and leaders in the Python open-source community with a mission to promote, educate and advance a diverse Python community through outreach, education, conferences, events and social gatherings. PyLadies similarly aims to provide a friendly support network for women and a bridge to the larger Python world. They encourage anyone with an interest in Python to participate.

Ngombor

Ngombor Community Development Alliance is a Community Based Organization based in Nebbi District of Uganda. Ngombor envisions communities with resilient food production systems and biodiversity. To achieve that Ngombor is working towards establishing a permaculture demonstration farm that will train the local community in permaculture practice.

We believe that Permaculture plays a vital role in agrifood systems by promoting sustainable food production through practices that mimic natural ecosystems, emphasizing biodiversity, soil health, water conservation, and minimizing reliance on external inputs like chemical fertilizers and pesticides, ultimately contributing to a more resilient and environmentally friendly food system. Our collaboration with PyLadies Uganda aims to bring and merge modern technology with rural agriculture.

Participants from Ngombor

#	Name	Role	Gender*
1	Ulargiw K. Vincent	Secretary	M
2	Ofoyrwoth Cosma	Youth Developmen t Coordinator	M
3	Laurine Afoyorwoth	Chairperson	F
4	Lekuru Winny Hope	Treasurer	F

* Gender is noted because having gender equality baked into all our activities. It is an important value for us, so we track it.

Objectives

- To attain knowledge and skills in basic/introduction to data science and programing languages
- To meet with the PyLadies to share experience and strategize on the modalities of collaboration

Methodology

The meeting was through lecture and participatory discussion guided by an expert in data science who introduced the participants to types of data, importance of data, scientific analysis of data and simple program language which was majorly practical.

Because of the distance to Kampala, participants travelled to Kampala on Friday and returned on Sunday.

Achievement

- It was a good experience for all the participants
- Participants were able to learn scientific system of data management
- The two organizations were able to agree on collaboration
- We were able to meet and share experience with other participant
- Most participants had never been to Kampala and getting a tour from PyLadies will help participants be comfortable accessing future opportunities in Kampala

Challenges

- One of our participants had no prior knowledge of IT
    - Pyladies were very welcoming and supportive
    - The participant still got benefit from the meetup
    - See recommendations and participant experiences for more details
- Language barrier for some participants especially from Ngombor team
    - Other Ngombor members were able to translate to Alur, but it added a challenge, especially as some words do not yet exist in Alur.
- Being new to Python and attending the meetup for the first time, everything was challenging
    - PyLadies were supportive of our learning curve.

Recommendations

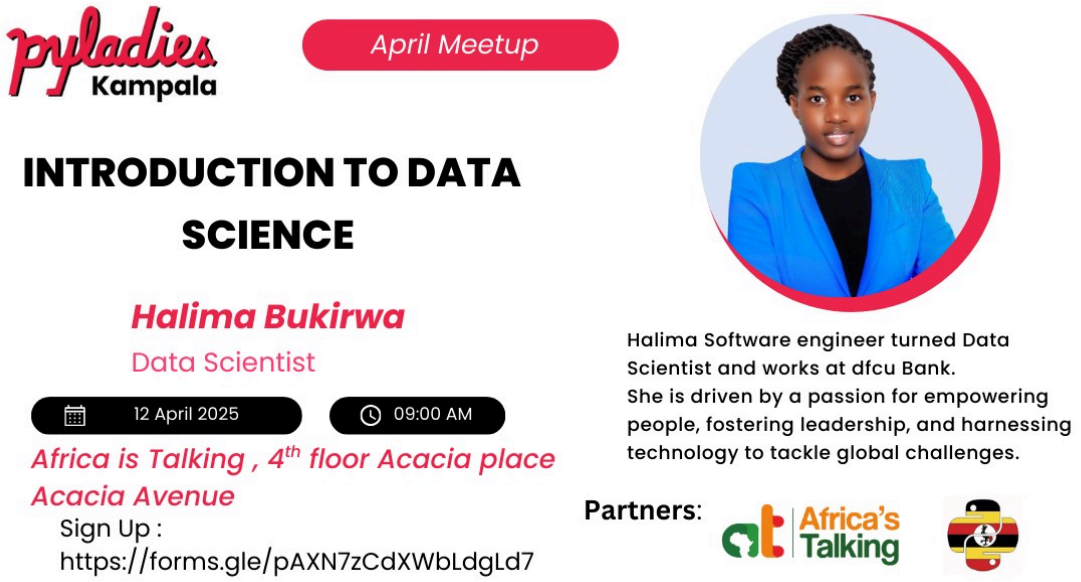
- Bring more female youth participants (Laurine and Winny are committee members and community leaders)
- We need to get a good laptop with a well-functioning webcam, so that some trainings can be held online. Meeting monthly is not enough when all of the participants are beginners.
- This meetup was very valuable for community leaders to understand and explore the potential of IT and data science. However, before attending another PyLadies meetup more participants should have basic IT literacy and access to a computer so that they can practice the skills learned.
- Create a local IT meetup, we plan to start with basic IT literacy.

Summary

The meetup was awesome and the participants were very excited about it. They appreciated and applaud those who supported the training. It highlighted that such meetup/training is very vital for small regional organizations like Ngombor in order for it to achieve its aims and objectives at a steady pace.

Appendix: Further resources

PyLadies announcement



The PyLadies Kampala April Meetup is happening on saturday 12/04/2025.

We're thrilled to have Halima Bukirwa a data scientist at DFCU, who will be sharing insights ✨

Topic: Introduction to Data Science

📅 12 April, 2025

📍 Africa's Talking Acacia Place

🕒 09:00am-12 noon

Want to start in Data Science but don't know where to begin?

Don't worry —this meetup, we'll break it all down for you.

This month, we'll be exploring Data Science fundamentals and how you can get started.

Stories/Testimonials

Hi everyone, I would like to appreciate all the people who supported us during yesterday's training at PyLadies, we were so much impressed and excited to be part of the team as we represent the women from Ngombor CDA. This was an awesome experience that we shall leave to remember as we share with other members.

The concept of data science being very new and is a challenge for women especially in rural settings we approached it with alot of fear but we were highly encouraged, coupled to the fact that my colleague had never touched a computer it was a areal dream come true.

However, at least even at that level she was able grasp something as she expressed her excitement and appreciation. She said as a committed subsistence farmer based in a rural setting she learnt theoretical lessons mostly on how much data is vital in decision naking, she stated that she does farming on small scale for both home consumption and for sale but she didn't know that during every season she should have been keeping record of what she does e.g size of land, crops to plant, seeds to buy, how much spent, how much sold, all her expenses to help aid her decisions in the next planting season, which she said she will start using that through the old way in like using a book because the technology might be hard for her.

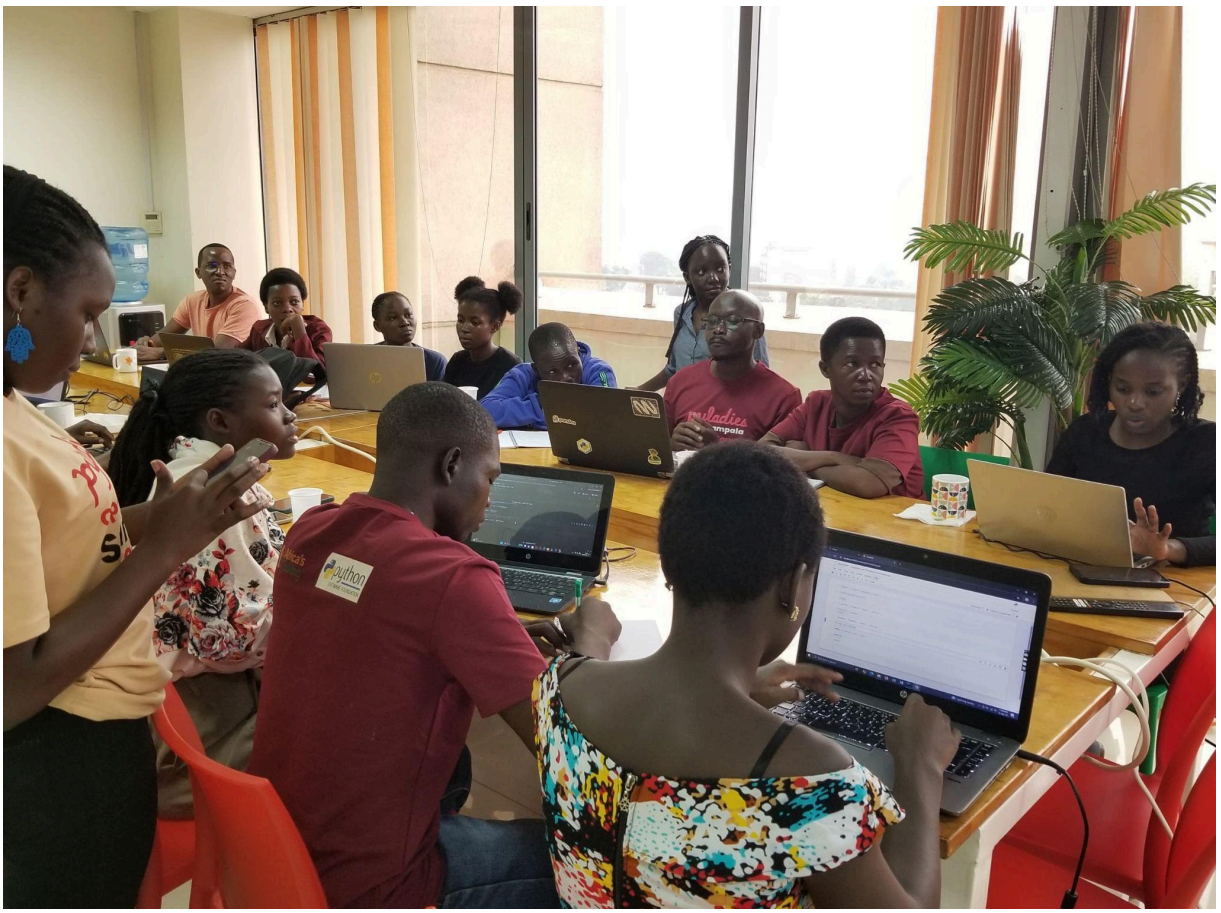
She therefore pledged to encouraging her children and other community members to take on the benefits brought about by technology especially in the use of computers.

- Winny, Community Development Officer, Nebbi

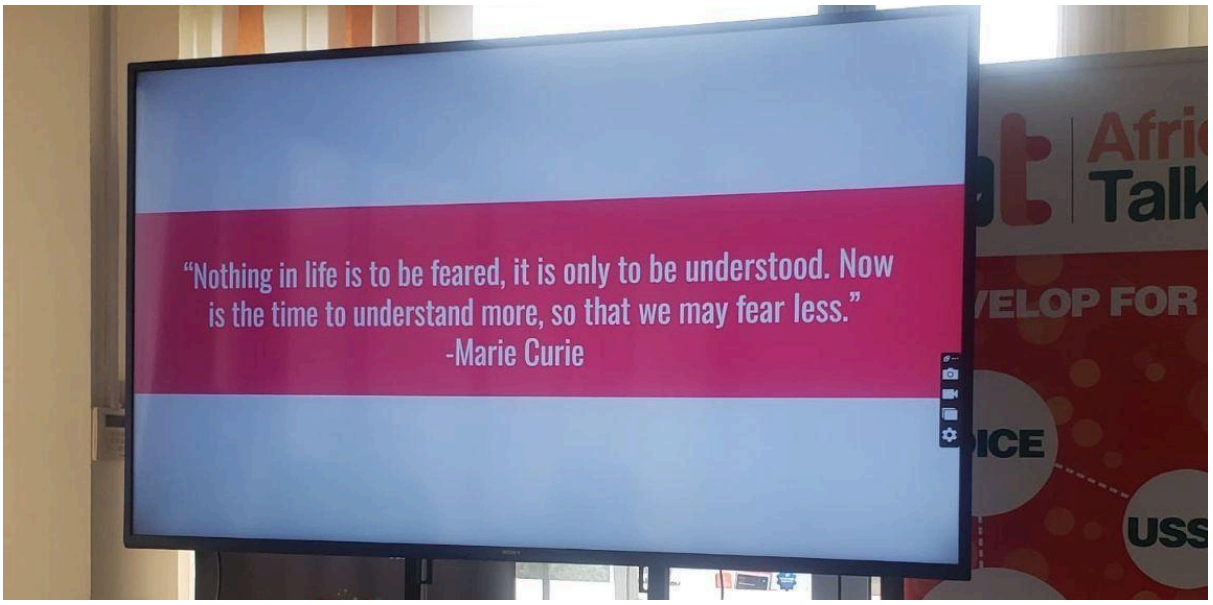
Photos

Bridging the Digital Divide photo album

pyladies
Kampala
Open-Source
Summit
2024



The Role of Artificial Intelligence in Achieving the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals
https://sdg-action.org/can-ai-help-us-achieve-the-sdgs/
https://ai-for-sdgs.academy/
Article
Africa's Talking
SMS
USSD
AIRTIME


"Nothing in life is to be feared, it is only to be understood. Now is the time to understand more, so that we may fear less."
-Marie Curie

pyladies
Kampala
Open-Source
Summit